

***Inheritance* is the idea of basing one class on another class so the new class can use the existing methods and attributes. When your classes are modeled on similar things, use inheritance rather than starting a new class.**

Imagine you want to model a book, so you write a class called `Book`. The class attributes might be `author`, `title`, and `subject`, and methods might be `describe_book()`, `show_sample_page()`, and `review_book()`. An ebook is a kind of book, so you could make `EBook` inherit from `Book` so it has all the attributes and methods of `Book`. Then you only need to define any additional attributes and methods specific to ebooks, such as a `file_size` attribute and a `download_book()` method.

In this example, `Book` is a *parent class* and `EBook` is a *child class*. A child class inherits from the parent class. When you write a child class, you can add any attributes or methods not in the parent class, as well as customize the behaviors inherited from the parent class.